

Detailed Exam Answers

18/05/2026

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Unclassified / Cross-Module Q2. Critically Evaluate the Concept of Sustainable Development as ...
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Corporate Environmental Responsibility (CER) is the responsibility of companies to reduce...



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All The answer should be a detailed answer with proper examples and images.
The answers should be in a simple language while preserving the important keywords of the answer.
You can give the answer from the reference book mentioned but please give images also.
Make sure you give detailed content for according to 10 marks answer.
Did you understand ?
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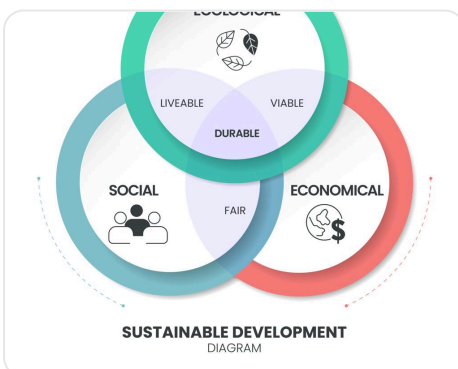
Unclassified / Cross-Module Q2. Critically Evaluate the Concept of Sustainable Development as a Multidimensional Approach — How Does it Reconcile Conflicting Goals of Economic Growth, Environmental Conservation, and Social Equity?

Sustainable Development is a development approach that aims to meet the needs of the **present generation without compromising the ability of future generations to meet their own needs**.

This definition was given in the **Brundtland Report (1987)** by the **World Commission on Environment and Development (WCED)**.

In simple words, sustainable development means **economic growth along with environmental protection and social well-being**.

It is called a **multidimensional approach** because it balances **economic, environmental, and social dimensions** of development.



Sustainable Development as a Multidimensional Approach

Sustainable development works through **three major dimensions (pillars)**:

1. Economic Dimension (Economic Growth)

Economic growth is necessary for:

- Employment generation
- Industrial development
- Poverty reduction
- Better living standards

Countries need economic development to improve infrastructure and quality of life.

However, uncontrolled economic growth can:

- Increase pollution
- Overuse natural resources
- Damage ecosystems

Example: Rapid industrialization increases GDP but may also increase air pollution.

2. Environmental Dimension (Environmental Conservation)

Environmental sustainability focuses on:

- Pollution control
- Biodiversity conservation
- Forest protection
- Resource conservation

The aim is to ensure natural resources remain available for future generations.

Environmental protection prevents:

- Climate change
- Deforestation
- Resource depletion

Example: Using renewable energy reduces environmental damage.

3. Social Dimension (Social Equity)

Social sustainability focuses on:

- Equality
- Education
- Healthcare
- Employment opportunities
- Poverty reduction

Development should benefit all sections of society.

This dimension ensures:

- Fair distribution of resources
- Improved quality of life

Example: Providing clean drinking water to all communities.

How Sustainable Development Reconciles Conflicting Goals

One major challenge is balancing:

- **Economic growth**
- **Environmental conservation**
- **Social equity**

These goals often conflict with each other.

Conflict 1: Economic Growth vs Environmental Protection

Industries promote economic growth but may increase:

- Pollution
- Resource depletion

Reconciliation

Sustainable development promotes:

- Green technology
- Cleaner production
- Renewable energy

Example: Solar energy supports industrial growth without heavy pollution.

Conflict 2: Economic Development vs Social Equality

Economic growth may benefit only a small group of people.

Reconciliation

Sustainable development ensures:

- Equal opportunities
- Fair resource distribution
- Poverty reduction

Example: Government welfare schemes improve social equity.

Conflict 3: Environmental Protection vs Human Needs

Conservation measures may restrict industrial or urban expansion.

Reconciliation

Sustainable development encourages:

- Sustainable agriculture
- Eco-friendly industries
- Responsible resource use

This balances environmental and human needs.

Principles of Sustainable Development

Important principles include:

1. Intergenerational Equity

Resources should be protected for future generations.

2. Resource Conservation

Natural resources should be used wisely.

3. Pollution Prevention

Reduce pollution at source.

4. Public Participation

Citizens should participate in environmental protection.

5. Equity and Justice

Benefits of development should reach everyone.

Critical Evaluation of Sustainable Development

Advantages

- Balances development and conservation
- Reduces environmental degradation
- Improves social welfare
- Promotes long-term economic growth

Limitations / Criticism

- Difficult to balance conflicting goals
- Expensive implementation
- Political and industrial resistance
- Developing countries face challenges

Example of Sustainable Development

A city using:

- Solar energy
- Waste recycling
- Water conservation

while creating jobs and improving public welfare is practicing sustainable development.

Conclusion

Sustainable development is a **multidimensional approach** that balances **economic growth, environmental conservation, and social equity**. By promoting **resource conservation, green technology, equal opportunities, and responsible development**, it helps reconcile conflicting goals and ensures a better future for both present and future generations.

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We covered:

- **Module 01** — Introduction to Environment & Sustainable Development
- **Module 02** — Global Environmental Concerns
- **Module 03** — Concepts of Ecology
- **Module 04** — Scope of Environmental Management & CER
- **Module 05** — TQEM & ISO 14000
- **Module 06** — Environmental Legislation
- **Cross-module / Unclassified Questions**

If you want, next I can:

1. **Improve weak answers** (add more marks-worthy points/keywords)
2. **Add better exam diagrams** for all answers
3. **Create one master revision document** with all answers in order
4. **Give 2-3 page exam-ready condensed versions** for fast revision before exam.



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Corporate Environmental Responsibility (CER) is the responsibility of companies to reduce environmental damage and conduct business in an eco-friendly and sustainable manner.

Example: Tata Group practices CER through tree plantation programs, water conservation, and pollution control initiatives.